

# Language development 1

## Reporting exact words

### 1 a Read the following and discuss the questions below.

Irene, who is British, first met her Romanian husband, Ilie, while she was on holiday in Bucharest. They now live in Bucharest.

- Do you think it's a good idea to marry someone from a different country? Would you do it? Do you know anyone who has?
- Would you be happy to live in his/her country?

### b Read what Irene says and answer the questions.

- 1 How did she meet her husband?
- 2 Is she happy?

I was staring at a painting in the National Art museum when this amazingly attractive man came up and asked me if I liked the painting. I replied that I'd seen it before in a book I have at home. He then said he'd been looking at me for the last few minutes and that he found me very attractive. I was embarrassed and told him to leave me alone. I said I didn't talk to strange men in art galleries. He asked me what the matter was and explained that he was just trying to be friendly. Then he smiled and asked me to join him for a coffee. I don't know why but I said I would, and that was the beginning of our romance. Somebody asked me last week if I regret marrying a foreigner and living abroad and I replied, 'Certainly not' and that I'm the happiest I've ever been in my life.



### c Complete the table with the exact words each person used.

#### Present simple

1 'I .....?'

#### Present continuous

2 'I ..... friendly.'

#### Present perfect (continuous)

3 'He ..... the painting before.'

4 'He ..... at me.'

#### Imperative

5 '..... alone.'

#### Request

6 '..... join him?'

#### Yes/No question

7 '..... painting?'

#### Wh-question

8 'What ..... the matter?'

#### No tense change

9 '..... marrying a foreigner?'

10 'I ..... happiest I've ever been.'

#### Past simple

She said she didn't talk to strange men.

#### Past continuous

He said he was just trying to be friendly.

#### Past perfect (continuous)

She replied that she'd seen the painting before.

He said he'd been looking at you.

#### tell + object + to + infinitive

I told him to leave me alone.

#### ask + object + to + infinitive

He asked me if I would join him.

He asked me if I liked the painting.

He asked me what the matter was.

They asked me if I regret marrying a foreigner.

I replied that I'm the happiest I've ever been.

- d Why is there no tense change in examples 9 and 10?
- e What does the past simple usually change to in reported speech?
- f What do these words and expressions usually change to?

today tomorrow yesterday last week  
next month this here come bring

2 Read the conversation, then complete the text below.

- TIM: Hi Sarah, it's Tim. What are you doing tonight?
- SARAH: You're nosy! Anyway, I'm studying.
- TIM: That's boring – come out for a meal instead.
- SARAH: Well, I've nearly finished, I suppose. Which restaurant do you have in mind?
- TIM: That new Indian one. I went there last week – it's great.
- SARAH: OK, then. Can you pick me up?
- TIM: Sure. I'll be there at seven.
- SARAH: Great. I must be back early though.

Tim took me out last night – he called and asked me (1)..... doing, so I said that (2)..... studying. He said (3)..... boring, and asked me (4)..... for a meal instead. I replied that (5)..... finished and asked him which restaurant he (6)..... in mind. He told me that he (7)..... the new Indian restaurant the previous week, and that (8)..... great. I asked him (9)..... up, and he said he (10)..... there at seven. I said I (11)..... back early.

- 3 a Tell each other about a person, place or pet that is important to you. As you listen, ask each other questions and make notes.
- b Report your conversations to the rest of the group.

### Reporting verbs

- 4 a Complete the 'report' of Sarah and Tim's conversation with these verbs.

accused agreed explained persuaded suggested

- Sarah ..... Tim of being nosy.
- Tim ..... Sarah to go out for a meal.
- She ..... to go out for a meal.
- Tim ..... going to the new Indian restaurant.
- He ..... that he'd been there before.

- b Write the verbs in Exercise 4a in the correct place in the table.

|                                 |  |
|---------------------------------|--|
| verb + to                       |  |
| verb + object + to              |  |
| verb + -ing                     |  |
| verb (+ object) + prep + -ing   |  |
| verb (+ object) + that + clause |  |

- c Now write these verbs in the correct place in the table.

admit advise apologise decide deny insist  
offer refuse remind recommend warn

- d Which verbs in Exercises 4b and c could go into more than one place in the table?

► Grammar reference page 197

5 Report what the people say, using a reporting verb from Exercise 4.

- 'You shouldn't get married yet,' Jane's father told her.  
Jane's father .....
- 'I started the argument,' Nadia said.  
Nadia .....
- 'I don't care what you say, I'm cooking dinner tonight,' Paul said.  
Paul .....
- 'Don't go out with Mike, he's not nice,' Adela told her sister.  
Adela .....
- 'I'm sorry if I hurt your feelings,' Nick told his girlfriend.  
Nick .....
- 'Why don't we stay in this weekend?' Mark said.  
Mark .....
- 'I'll carry that bag for you,' Marta said to her mother.  
Marta .....
- 'I'm not listening!' Carol said.  
Carol .....

6 Complete these sentences about yourself.

- Once I had to apologise ...
- ... asked me if ...
- ... persuaded me ...
- I've decided ...

7 Make sentences from these words.

- Sometimes people / suggest / marriage / old-fashioned idea.
- Parents often / persuade / children / get married.
- Some people / insist / get married / while / still teenagers.
- One couple / admit / get married / for financial reasons.
- Some couples / refuse / have / religious wedding.
- A few women / decide / not / change their surname.